

**PS5 jailbroken!**

Sony's newest console has been jailbroken. However, the new exploit is still in nascent stages. <https://digit.in/oct22-35>

**A hand of friendship**

Google Messages is rolling out reactions for SMS compatible with Apple iMessage. <https://digit.in/oct22-36>

Oppo Enco Buds2

Decent budget option, but not the best

Back in September 2021, when we wrote our Oppo Enco Buds review, we said that “entry-level truly wireless earphones are improving at a meteoric rate”. Cut to August 2022, when its successor – the Oppo Enco Buds2 has launched in the market – the statement rings more true than ever. The market is rife with competition though, from companies such as Realme, OnePlus, Xiaomi, boAt, and others offering similarly-priced yet feature-rich TWS. So, does the Oppo Enco Buds2 succeed or is the grass greener elsewhere? Let's find out!

BUILD AND FIT

Oppo has gone ahead and revamped the design of its budget TWS offering this year sporting a vastly different design than the Oppo Enco Buds with its pill-shaped case and stem-less buds. The new circular charging case comes with subtle Oppo branding in the centre. The buds come in only one colour – black. The case and the buds sport a matte finish which feels premium for the price. It has a glossy black strip running across the circumference of the case. We would have liked a few more colour options though. It has a slim profile and is extremely easy to open one-handed but the hinge doesn't feel very robust. Opening the case reveals a black and pastel blue dual-tone design which looks pretty sweet. The Enco Buds 2 have long stems with responsive touch sensors embedded on the top of the stem. The fit of these earbuds is fantastic, and even with the addition of stems, Oppo has managed to keep the weight down to 4 g.

FEATURES

Priced under ₹2K, the Oppo Enco Buds2 have an array of features, however, some of these are reserved for users with Oppo phones only. The earbuds can leverage the HeyMelody app to check battery levels, perform



firmware updates, and customise controls. Users of ColorOS 11.0+ phones can find these options in the phone's settings itself. The earbuds also come packing other features such as Game Mode (which lowers latency down to 94 ms) and IPX4 splash and sweat resistance. However, Oppo has skimped out on dust ingress protection. You also get mono earbud usage, Bluetooth v5.2, and voice assistant support.

PERFORMANCE

Equipped with 10 mm dynamic titanised drivers, the earbuds come with a pleasant enough bass-boosted sound similar to the Realme Buds Air 3 Neo (with Balanced EQ preset) and the OG Enco Buds. The earbuds' default EQ preset has a warm quality with boosted and punchy bass and well-produced mids. The earbuds come with Dolby Atmos support but the soundstage is very narrow. The highs are slightly muted post the 4 kHz mark and that means that instruments such as cymbals and hi-hats will be a bit shrouded in the mix. The bass can get a bit overwhelming at times, and the details in the mids do get slightly

drowned due to auditory masking but we are just nitpicking here. At ₹1,799, this is perfectly good audio quality that most of the general public will enjoy. These buds don't come with Active Noise Cancellation, so you will have to rely on passive isolation which is decent enough and subdues ambient sounds. The microphone on these buds is pretty decent; they are improved when compared to the original Enco Buds due to the stem design which brings the mics closer to the mouth. The buds come with AI Noise Cancellation for calls based on a DNN (deep neural network) but we still found that external sounds were picked up.

BATTERY LIFE

In our battery tests, the earbuds lasted for 6 hours and 50 minutes. This was at 50 per cent volume. The charging case provides 3 extra charges with ease. There's also fast charging, so 10 minutes of charging time will provide an hour's worth of playback.

VERDICT

At ₹1,799, the Oppo Enco Buds2 is a value-for-money purchase with good bass-rich sound and an array of features to boot. You also get a pretty solid-looking, minimalist design and good fit. Coupled with the IPX4 rating, these are great workout earbuds for fitness enthusiasts. However, the problem arises when you look at competing feature-rich products in the market – especially the Realme Buds Air 3 Neo. If you get these on sale at around ₹1,200-₹1,400, we'd say buy them without any ounce of hesitation.

—Dhriti Datta



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SPECIFICATIONS

DRIVER SIZE: 10 mm | DRIVER TYPE: Titanised dynamic driver | FREQUENCY RESPONSE: 20 Hz - 20 kHz | BLUETOOTH CODECS: SBC, AAC | BLUETOOTH VERSION: 5.2 | WIRELESS RANGE: 10 m / 33 ft | WIRELESS PLAYTIME (BUDS): 7 hours | WIRELESS PLAYTIME (BUDS + CHARGING CASE): 28 hours | CHARGING TIME (BUDS): 90 minutes, 10 minutes for 1-hour playback

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